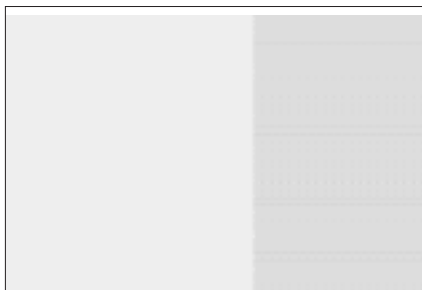


top of the left pane to auto-sort posts such that even those with fewer entries “rise above” the high-volume, high-frequency posts.

In the right pane, the actual post items are displayed. When you scroll through and read the posts, the unread posts count will start decreasing. If you have more than 100 unread posts, Reader will only show 100+ against the subscription. You can view the posts either in List View or Expanded View. In List View, you can quickly skim the headlines without having to wade through the content of each post. However, note that the post will only be marked as unread if you view it in Expanded View. If you do not wish a subscription to show up as unread even if you don’t read the posts, you can use the “Mark all as read” link at the top of the right pane. This will mark all items in the post as read and clear the unread count against the subscription in the left pane. If you want to leave a post as unread you can clear the “Mark as Read” checkbox at the bottom of the post item.



Your Shared Items public page

Special posts and those you want to review again later can be Starred. To mark a item with a star, click on the “Add Star” link at the bottom of the post.

You can also Share with friends the items in the feeds that you find. On a post that you want to share, click on the Share link at the bottom of the post. Then click on the “shared items” link at the top of the left pane. This will show you the link to your public page and also provide you with the JavaScript code that you can embed on your Web site to show a linked clip of your shared items.

The public page can also be subscribed to via RSS, and you can

share the address with your friends and family to let them look at what you are reading.

For easier viewing, you can organise the feeds in folders by going to the settings page (click on the link at the top right corner).

For each subscription, you can specify one or more tags. These tags will appear as hierarchical folders in Reader. Additionally, you can make these tags public and publish the items under these tags as RSS feeds. Similar to the shared page, each tag will have its own public page, and like with the shared items, you can also create a “webclip” for each public tag, which you can post to your site or blog.

Go to the Goodies tab under settings to see various other options on what you can do with Reader. You can include Reader on your personalised Google Homepage by clicking on the Add to Google gadget link. You can also put all Reader items in a “next” bookmark or limit it to one of your folders (tags). Drag and drop the bookmark to your bookmarks/links folder. Clicking on Next will open the reader to the latest post, and subsequent clicks will enable you to see each successive subscription at the original site. This may be useful when you only get a snippet in your post and wish to read the full post.



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You can use the Import/Export tab to import your subscriptions from another RSS reader, or export your Google Reader subscriptions. Both Import and Export follow the industry standard for subscriptions file format, known as OPML.